



go-to device for a bit of late-night reading while plugged in. You can also enjoy reading comic books and other graphic novels in full colour on a tablet compared to something like a Kindle.

Tablets with their chunkier size can also be used as display extensions for things like live feeds that you need to take a look at from time-to-time. And just like smartphones, tablets can also be used as a bedside clock. If however, you have a tablet that is not too old, you can do a bit more than just use it as a display device. For example, you can use it as a voice assistant and it can also be used as a universal remote for your smarthome. Of course, the chances of people having a smarthome in India is rare, and the few who do, wouldn't be interested in repurposing an older tablet, though it is also good for the environment, so maybe that's their carrot?

MONITOR'S AND TVS

Similar to tablets, older desktop monitors and TVs can also be used as secondary display extensions for live feeds. It can especially be useful for journalists to view the trending news without minimising their main window and even for people working in the finance sector to view multiple markets simultaneously. It can also be used to keep an eye on a CCTV camera while working on a monitor.



When it comes to TVs, consumers are often left a bit handicapped due to the atrocious and slow UI's that most TV's come with. Well, the mainstream solution to that would be to get something like an Amazon Fire TV stick to give the UI a well deserved makeover. You could also use a TV as a photo frame to display family photos. If the TV is totally dead, you could remove the panel, replace it with a mirror, print out a few breaking news stickers, add a news headline that says "World's most beautiful human found", and now everyone who looks at it will let out a giggle, and it's a conversation starter!

LAPTOPS

Laptops end up being a pretty versatile devices to reuse. Let's assume you have an old laptop with outdated



hardware and a cracked display. Rather than chucking it in the bin, it can be flashed to run Linux, or at least a version of Linux that is super light and does not require too much grunt from the processor, RAM and GPU. Now that you have a stable and light Operating System, you can connect your laptop with a TV via HDMI and use it as a media centre. Install all the latest streaming apps on it, or simply stream from the browser. The possibilities for entertainment are pretty much endless. You also end up getting much more internal storage than most other media centres so you can download video content in the best resolution available and not be worried about clogging up the memory banks. To make this setup work from the comfort of your couch, you might need a wireless keyboard and mouse. This gives new life to an old laptop as well as an old TV whose

software was never much to write home about anyway.

If the laptop is not in working condition anymore, you can still strip it for parts – hard drives, display and in some cases even the battery. Add a pinch of DIY to the mix, a hint of creativity and you might end up with something insanely useful as well.

PC

Like laptops, older PCs are also quite versatile in terms of usability. Maybe even more than laptops. One of the best solutions to make use of older components like the motherboard, CPU, RAM and PSU is to convert the system into a NAS entertainment unit. You will need some internal hard drives which can be sourced from old and forgotten PC's. There are many tutorials online on converting an old PC into a media centre, NAS, web server, or a myriad of other uses. All you need to do is pick the one which is most suited for you and follow the steps.

If the system is not in working order, then once again, salvaging parts for other builds is the name of the game. One of the simplest things you can do is save the hard drives from eternal damnation by converting them to external hard drives. By doing this, you not only save all the data on the device, but you also get a portable hard drive that in most cases end up being cheaper than equivalent external hard drives. If



you are feeling a bit creative, there are tons of videos online on how you can make aesthetic art pieces with things like fried motherboards. You're really only limited by your creativity, and who knows, if you're really creative you could start an art business. If you do, make an artwork for us as well! 